

TAB 19



Board of Education Report

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Mr. Schmerelson - Fostering Healthy Relationships through Digital Citizenship Week (Res-007-24/25) (For Action October 22, 2024)

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District has established the Instructional Technology Initiative (ITI) with its mission to focus on providing professional opportunities on instructional frameworks that leverage technology in purposeful and personalized ways;

Whereas, The ITI coordinates and collaborates with various district departments as well as external partners to serve the needs of District students;

Whereas, The ITI has established mandatory digital citizenship classes for students, exploring topics such as artificial intelligence, responsible digital use, and social media lessons to help build a responsible digital culture in the classroom and beyond;

Whereas, The District distributes professional development opportunities for teachers over the summer that focus on best practices to incorporate technology as a tool to better instruct and manage classroom settings;

Whereas, The LAUSD community is constantly surrounded by technological advancements, whether they are in the classroom, at home, in public spaces, or taking public transit, among other areas;

Whereas, The District is expanding opportunities for eSports programs that incorporate STEAM curriculum, allowing students an accessible pathway into the arts and sciences;

Whereas, The District has established the 2024 Digital Citizenship Challenge, incorporating leaderboards and prizes for the schools that meet or exceed digital citizenship standards;

Whereas, Digital Citizenship fits into LAUSD's strategic plan, focusing on pillars 1A (high-quality instruction), 1C (eliminating opportunity gaps), 2B (whole-child well-being), and 2C (strong social-emotional skills);

Whereas, Academic settings maintain a responsibility to their students to foster a safe environment, teaching students about subjects such as civic engagement and being responsible citizens while addressing the negative impacts of cyberbullying and the difference between truths, half-truths, lies, facts, and opinions;

Whereas, The Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District passed the Critical Media Literacy resolution on March 9, 2021, specifically addressing the misinformation campaigns on Instagram, Facebook, and Twitter/X, among other social media platforms, and what the District can do to teach students about online misinformation;

Whereas, The rise of artificial intelligence has posed a danger to student learning, taking content from the internet and reflecting information to users as factual even when it is to the contrary; and

Whereas, Studies also show that widespread damage of misinformation has a direct cause of violence, rejection of modern medicine/science, and increase in depression and suicide among student populations and their families and others; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District will acknowledge the week of Monday, October 16 to Sunday, October 22, 2024, as Digital Citizenship Week;

Resolved further, That all students will complete the Digital Citizenship course to demonstrate ability to discern online scams, AI manipulation and forms of digital misinformation and cyberbullying;

Resolved further, That the Board recommends that the superintendent or a designee oversee opportunities for parents and guardians to participate in Digital Citizenship Week through the parent center, email updates, and other appropriate mediums to teach them about online scams, AI manipulation in pictures and videos, and best practices for such instances; and, be it finally

Resolved, That District staff will update the Board regarding this matter no later than May 2025 through a presentation during that month's Committee of the Whole or through an informative.